Sarah Thomas
New Mexico State University
Computer Science Department
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Education

New Mexico State University - Computer Science, Doctor of Philosophy, Current

- Dissertation Advisor: Christabel Wayllace
- Artificial Intelligence for Arid Land Agriculture Fellow

Georgia Institute of Technology - Master of Science in Computer Science, December 2024

- Major: Computer Science
- Specialization: Interactive Intelligence

New Mexico State University - Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, May 2016

- Major: Computer Science

Academic Positions

- Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Computer Science, New Mexico State University, 2025-2026.
- Teaching Assistant, Department of Computer Science, New Mexico State University, 2026.
- Undergraduate student co-advisor, Department of Computer Science, New Mexico State University, 2026.

Fellowships and Awards

- Artificial Intelligence for Arid Land Agriculture Fellow, 2025-2026.

Selected Works in Progress

- Communicating Risk of Deep Reinforcement Learning Models to Lay Users
- Red Chile Irrigation Using Reinforcement Learning: Bridging the Simulation-to-Real Gap

Industry Experience

Senior Software Engineer - My Well Ministry, 2023 - 2024

- Programming in C#, Vue Js., React, and SQL
- Working closely with UI designers to create interfaces that best serve users
- Implementing projects in technologies less familiar to the team to pave the way for future solutions

Senior Technical Consultant - Huron Consulting Group, 2022-2023

- Customizing research administration software such as IRB and Conflict of Interest management systems

- Programming features in JavaScript and SQL
- Modifying software solutions to meet unique client needs in the most cost-effective manner
- Writing detailed test cases to provide the testing team with the information needed to test effectively

Software Development Team Leader - Faith Comes By Hearing, 2021 - 2022

- Teaching team technical trainings
- One-on-one mentoring
- Assigning tasks to developers based on their particular skills to maximize team productivity
- Leading agile development meetings such as sprint planning and retrospective meetings to support timeline planning and continual growth in the team's development processes
- Full-stack web and desktop application development

Software Development Team Leader - Steele Consulting Group 2018-2021

- Teaching team technical sessions
- Conducting regular code reviews
- Assisting junior developers and interns

Software Developer - Steele Consulting Group 2016-2018

- Full-stack development using a variety of languages and technologies to meet client needs, including JavaScript, jQuery, TypeScript, Angular, AngularJS, C#(.Net), ASP .Net MVC, HTML, CSS, and SQL
- Implementing a variety of software applications, including mobile apps, websites, and APIs, in accordance with designer specifications and client requirements